

PROJECT HOMESTEAD

Feasibility of Civilian Life and Enterprise in the Pokemon World

A Strategy and Business Analysis Report

Strategy and Business Analysis

Prepared July 2026

All company and place identifiers in this report are drawn from published fictional source material. All financial figures are modelled and directional.

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1. Engagement Context

This report asks a simple question dressed up in a complicated setting. If an ordinary person, not a Pokemon Trainer, wanted to move into the Pokemon world today, keep common Pokemon as pets, and run a business, where should they go and what should they do? The question matters because almost every existing account of the Pokemon world is told from a Trainer's point of view. The Trainer travels, battles, and collects badges. The civilian stays put, pays rent, keeps a pet, and needs an income. That is a different life with different priorities, and it has barely been examined.

The question splits into three working parts. Where is safe and liveable. What does keeping Pokemon as pets actually cost. And which kind of business, a normal consumer one or a Pokemon related one, gives the best return for the risk taken. That is an issue tree, not a slogan, and every section that follows answers one branch of it.

1.1 Scope and boundaries

Two boundaries matter and should be stated plainly. The person in this report is not a Trainer. They do not battle, they do not collect Gym badges, and they are not trying to become Champion. Their Pokemon are pets, not a competitive roster, and only common, non legendary species are considered for that role. Anything with a myth attached to it, anything that ends a region's story arc, stays out of the pet shortlist entirely.

The geographic scope is the nine core regions of the mainline games, Kanto, Johto, Hoenn, Sinnoh, Unova, Kalos, Alola, Galar, and Paldea. Spin off settings and the anime only locations are left out, because their internal detail is thinner and harder to hold to the same standard of evidence. The time scope is the present day, defined properly in the next section, so that a region is judged on how it is now rather than on a crisis it lived through years ago.

1.2 Method and frameworks

The analysis treats the published lore of the games the way a consultant treats a client's internal documents, as the record of what happened rather than marketing copy. Where the source is genuinely vague, this report says so and states the assumption instead of quietly filling the gap. The evidence base is the mainline games themselves, cross checked against two long standing reference works, Bulbapedia and Serebii, which between them catalogue the games' locations, species distribution, and confirmed developer statements.

Each section is anchored to a named framework rather than a generic template. The engagement is broken down with an issue tree and checked for gaps with a MECE test. The regional choice is treated as a market entry decision and resolved through a weighted scoring matrix. Daily life and pet ownership are examined by mapping the people and institutions a resident deals with and weighing pet upkeep as a cost benefit question. The general consumer business is framed with the three Cs, Porter's five forces, and the marketing mix. The Pokemon related business is framed with a SWOT and a value chain. The two are combined and ranked with a weighted matrix and a written business case, and the chosen venture's future is mapped with the Ansoff matrix and the BCG growth share matrix. Implementation uses McKinsey's seven S model, and the risk section uses a probability and impact register alongside scenario planning. The frameworks are chosen to fit the actual problem, not repeated by default.

1.3 The currency basis

One assumption runs through every number in this report, so it is worth settling first. The games make the currency easy. In the original Japanese releases the money on screen is yen, shown with the yen symbol,

meanwhile the Pokedollar most players know, is a Western localisation choice rather than a separate economy (Bulbapedia, n.d.) therefore one Pokedollar is treated as one Japanese yen throughout. That is less an assumption than reading the original text correctly, and it lets the cost figures borrow sensibly from real Japanese price levels where the games leave a gap.

1.4 A note on the limits of the figures

Every financial figure here is modelled. The games price a Potion and a Poke Ball, but they do not price rent, wages, or the upkeep of a pet, and the prices they do give never vary by region. So the cost work is built from a small set of canon anchors scaled by clearly stated assumptions, and it is presented as directional rather than exact. The scoring is the same. A weighted matrix turns judgement into numbers so the judgement can be argued with, not so it can pretend to be measurement. Read the numbers as a structured opinion with its workings shown, which is what they are.

2. World Timeline and Present-Day Baseline

Every region here is judged on how dangerous it is today, not on what happened to it once. That distinction only works if there is an actual today to measure from, so this section builds one.

The developers have never committed to a single strict timeline across the whole series, and the reference record says as much directly (Bulbapedia, n.d.). What does exist is a set of relative gaps confirmed piece by piece, the most useful being the statement that Pokémon Legends Z-A takes place five years after the events of X and Y (Bulbapedia, n.d.) Stitching those confirmed gaps together gives a working relative calendar, Year 0 for the earliest stories through to Year 13 for the Z-A era, which this report treats as the present day baseline. It is a modelled timeline built from real developer statements, but it is still a model and should be read that way.

Region	Game(s)	Yr	Crisis / Signature Event	Status Today
Kanto	Red / Blue / Yellow, FireRed / LeafGreen	0	Team Rocket (Silph Co. takeover, Game Corner, Mt. Moon fossil theft)	Resolved
Hoenn	Ruby / Sapphire / Emerald, ORAS	0	Team Aqua and Team Magma, Groudon and Kyogre awakened	Resolved, weather-legendary tail risk remains
Johto	Gold / Silver / Crystal, HeartGold / SoulSilver	3	Team Rocket reformation attempt, Radio Tower takeover	Resolved
Sinnoh	Diamond / Pearl / Platinum, BDSP	6	Team Galactic, attempt to remake the universe via the lake trio	Resolved
Unova	Black / White, Black 2 / White 2	8	Team Plasma, ideology of Pokémon liberation	Resolved
Kalos	X / Y	8	Team Flare, ultimate weapon threat	Resolved
Alola	Sun / Moon, Ultra Sun / Ultra Moon	9	Aether Foundation and Ultra Beasts, Ultra Wormholes	Resolved, standing Ultra Wormhole tail risk
Galar	Sword / Shield	11	Chairman Rose, the Darkest Day and Eternatus	Resolved
Paldea	Scarlet / Violet	12	Area Zero expedition, Terastal phenomenon	Resolved, Area Zero remains a controlled frontier
Kalos (Z-A)	Pokémon Legends Z-A	13	Lumiose redevelopment era, present-day anchor	Present-day baseline

Do note that Pokémon Legends Arceus is not taken into consideration as it takes place around 150 years before the event of Diamond and Pearl, while it goes by a different name, ancient Hisui is now modern Sinnoh.

Read that table as a resolved history file, not a threat list. Kanto's Team Rocket problem is thirteen years cold. Johto's is ten. Even Kalos, the most recent of the classic villain team stories, sits five years back, and the Z-A era is a city rebuilding around that scar rather than still bleeding from it. The pattern holds across the board. Each region's headline crisis was resolved at the end of its own story, and nothing in the source material suggests any of them reopened.

The two exceptions are worth separating out, because they are the reason the danger scoring later is not uniform. Most regional crises reduce to a defeated villain team, which is a closed problem. A standing natural phenomenon is not. Alola carries the Ultra Wormhole phenomenon, the tears in space the Aether Foundation never fully sealed, which remain a rare but real hazard rather than a beaten enemy (Game Freak, 2016). Paldea carries Area Zero, the great crater at the centre of the region, which is stabilised and studied rather than closed off entirely (Game Freak, 2022). Neither is a crisis in progress. Both are live

background risks, and they are treated as such in the regional danger scores rather than lumped in with old crime.

3. Regional Comparison

Choosing a region to live in is a market entry decision with the country swapped for a fictional one. The tools do not change. You still need to know how attractive the market is, how hard it is to get established there, and what could go wrong once you are in. The nine core regions are scored against a common set of criteria, ranked, and then narrowed to a single region and a single town.

3.1 The criteria and their weights

Nine regions are scored on seven criteria. Safety, Economic opportunity, Affordability, Climate and Lifestyle fit, common pet availability and suitability, and then culture split into two separate scores. The weights are 22% on safety, 18% on economy, 14% on affordability, 12% on climate, 14% on pets, and 10% each on the two culture scores. Safety carries the most weight, because a civilian relocating on modest means cannot easily absorb a serious personal risk. Economy comes next, because the plan has to pay for itself. Affordability and pet suitability matter almost equally, since the whole point of the move is a liveable life with animals in it. Climate is real but softer, so it sits lowest of the single criteria. Culture takes 20% between its two halves, which is a deliberate choice explained next.

3.2 Reading culture on two axes

Culture is scored as two things rather than one, because battle culture and rural culture are not the same and a region can be heavy on one and light on the other. The first axis measures how warm and welcoming the rural and community side of a region is. The second measures how much daily life is dominated by competitive battling, stadiums, and the Gym or trial circuit, scored so a higher number means less of that pressure. A civilian with no interest in badges cares about both, and they pull in different directions, so one number would hide the thing that actually matters.

Alola is the clearest case for the two axis approach. It is a warm, communal place, and it is also genuinely battle heavy. The island challenge, the trial captains, and the kahuna ceremonies run right through island life (Bulbapedia, n.d), so on battle pressure it scores middling at best. What saves it, and what a single culture score would miss, is that its rural and community culture is about the warmest on the list. The idea of ohana, the welcome a newcomer gets, the way trials are communal events rather than private contests, all of that is real and it matters to someone settling in (Game Freak, 2016). So Alola reads honestly here. Battle intense, but so warm and open that a civilian still fits.

Kanto is the mirror image. It scores fine on battle pressure, since the Gym circuit is present but does not run daily life, yet it falls down on rural warmth. Kanto is greater Tokyo with towns attached, and it has never carried a strong countryside identity the way Johto or Alola does (Bulbapedia, n.d). Kalos is the hard case, strong on both. The French countryside is genuinely part of its character, so rural warmth scores well, but battling and prestige culture are just as strong, so the calm score is low, and the two cancel to middling. Johto sits where you want to be, strong rural warmth from a Kansai base full of old towns and farm routes, and a battle culture that is present but never overwhelming.

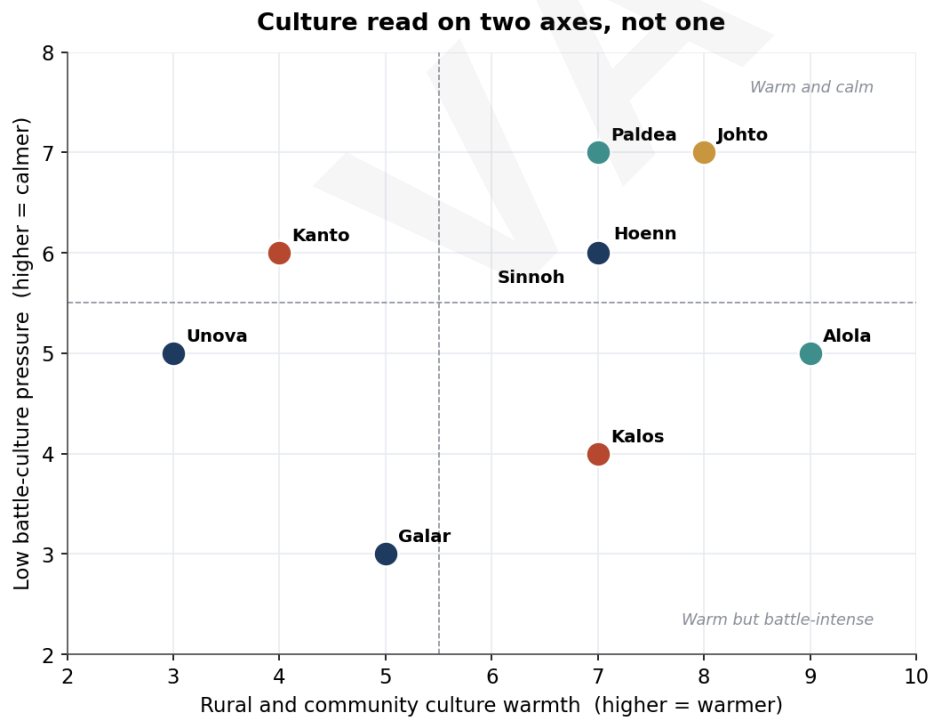


Figure 1. Culture read on two axes. Warm and calm is the top right corner. Warm but battle intense is the bottom right.

3.3 The scored comparison

Region	Safety	Econ	Afford	Climate	Pets	Rural	Low Batt	Total	Rank
Johto	9	6	7	7	7	8	7	7.36	1
Paldea	6	7	7	8	8	7	7	7.04	2
Alola	6	6	6	9	8	9	5	6.84	3
Kanto	8	7	6	7	8	4	6	6.82	4
Hoenn	6	6	8	8	7	7	6	6.76	5
Sinnoh	8	5	9	4	6	7	6	6.54	6
Galar	7	8	6	6	6	5	3	6.18	7
Kalos	5	8	3	8	7	7	4	6.00	8
Unova	6	9	4	6	6	3	5	5.86	9

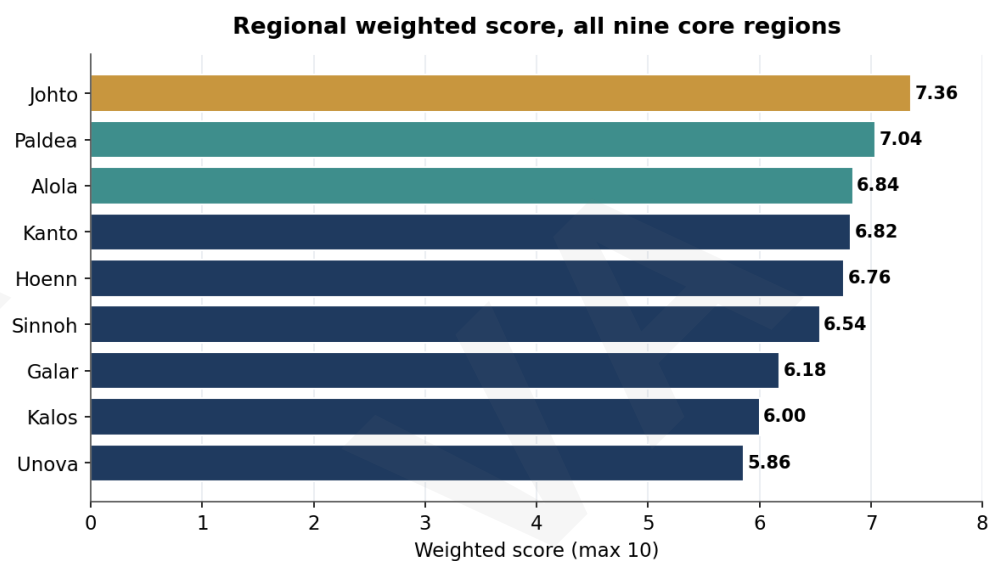


Figure 2. Regional weighted score, all nine core regions, sorted highest to lowest.

Johto comes out on top, and it is worth admitting that is not the obvious answer. Most casual takes on this question land on Kanto, because it is the region everyone meets first, or on Alola, because warm weather photographs well. Johto wins for less glamorous reasons. Its own villain team story was the weakest of the nine, a second, poorly resourced attempt by an organisation already dismantled once ((Game Freak, 1999.)). Its geography draws on Kansai rather than one hyper dense city, which keeps the cost of living down without tipping into the remoteness of somewhere like Sinnoh (Bulbapedia, n.d). And nothing about daily life in Johto revolves around competitive battling the way it does in Galar.

Paldea takes second, and it earns the place rather than being handed it. It is the newest region, which cuts both ways. The economy is the most open of the settled regions, there is room to start something before the market fills in, and the Mediterranean climate and food culture make daily life easy (Bulbapedia, n.d.). Its academy sets the social tone rather than a Gym circuit, so battle pressure is low, and Spanish village life gives it real rural warmth. The mark against it is maturity. Area Zero is a controlled frontier rather than a closed book, and the local institutions a new resident leans on are younger and less settled than Johto's (Game Freak, 2022). Second place is the honest read, strong on almost everything, held back only by being new.

Alola takes third, and it is the pick for anyone who weights lifestyle above the last point of safety. The two axis culture score is exactly why it rates well here rather than being dismissed as a holiday postcard. It is warm, communal, and welcoming in a way no other region matches, and the cost of that is a real if rare tail risk from the Ultra Wormhole phenomenon plus island import prices that push the cost of living up (Game Freak, 2016). Take the wormhole risk away and it would push above Johto much harder.

Kanto is fourth, and that is the biggest departure from the answer most people would guess. It is the region everyone meets first, it is safe, and it is familiar, and none of that is nothing. But once culture is scored properly it slips. The thin rural identity costs it, and there is nothing in its economy or cost base strong enough to make that back (Bulbapedia, n.d.). Kanto is the comfortable choice, not the optimised one, and if this report is to be honest, the two are not the same.

The middle of the table is worth a line each, because ruling a region out is a finding too. Hoenn scores well on affordability and climate but sits sixth on safety thanks to the weather legendary history, which keeps a faint tail risk on the books (Bulbapedia, n.d.). Sinnoh is cheap and safe but genuinely remote and cold, a Hokkaido in all but name, with the climate score dragging it down (Bulbapedia, n.d.). Galar has a strong economy but the heaviest stadium culture of the nine, which is precisely the thing a civilian may be trying to avoid. Kalos and Unova rule themselves out as first moves for anyone on modest capital. Both are exciting and both have strong economies, but both are expensive, Unova on New York prices and Kalos on Paris ones, and Kalos carries the added weight of being the most recently unsettled of the classic regions (Bulbapedia, n.d.). They are good places to visit but hard places to land cold.

3.4 How the cost and housing figures were built

The money figures need explaining, because the games do no help on their own. Prices in the games do not vary by region. A Potion costs the same in Lumiose as it does in a one road village, which is not how a real economy behaves. So the cost figures here are built, not lifted, and the method is set out openly so it can be checked.

The base is a basket of goods with canon prices. A Poke Ball is 200, a Potion 300, a Full Restore 3000, and so on, and because those numbers are literally yen in the Japanese releases, the one to one Pokedollar to yen treatment is reading the source correctly rather than assuming (Bulbapedia, n.d.). On top of the canon

items sit a few modelled staples, a berry, a cafe meal, a boutique item, priced from the conventions the games do show. That basket gives a single reference cost that can then be scaled from region to region.

Housing is the piece the games never price at all, so it is modelled openly. The method is simple. Take a Japanese mid size city monthly rent as a baseline, one figure for an in town apartment and a higher one for a smallholding with land, then scale both by the same regional multiplier used for the basket. That multiplier comes from each region's confirmed real world basis (Bulbapedia, n.d.). Kanto is priced like greater Tokyo, Kalos like Paris, Sinnoh like rural Hokkaido, Unova like New York, and Johto sits on the 1.00 baseline as mid range Kansai. So an Olivine apartment lands near 55 thousand a month and a Route 39 smallholding near 80 thousand, both at Johto's multiplier of one. None of these are audited numbers. They are directional, internally consistent, and every one of them traces to a cell in the accompanying workbook.

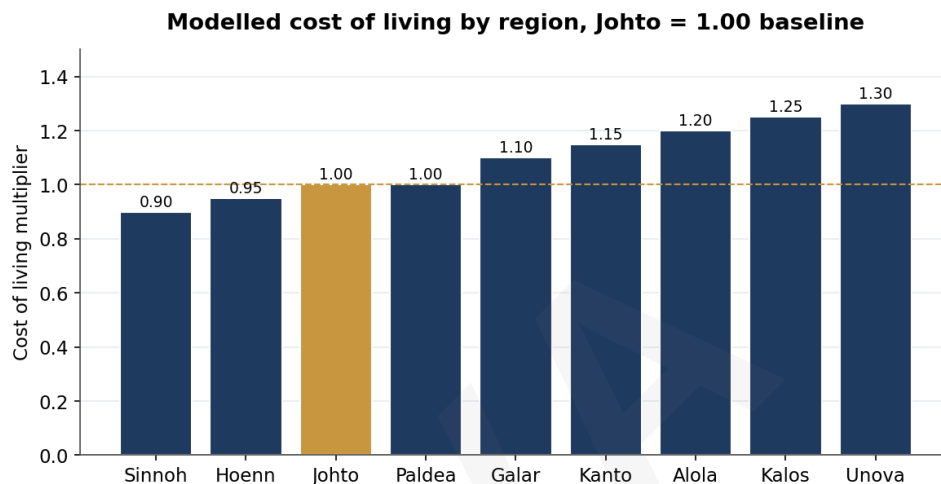


Figure 3. Modelled cost of living multiplier by region, Johto set as the 1.00 baseline.

3.5 The recommended region and city

Within Johto, Olivine City is the specific recommendation, and the scores only tell part of why. Olivine is a working port town rather than a tourist backdrop, which matters for the business sections that follow (Bulbapedia, n.d.). It is close enough to Ecruteak's cultural weight and Cianwood's calm to avoid feeling isolated, and small enough that a new business does not open into an already saturated market the way it would in Goldenrod.

There is also a softer layer that the raw scores do not capture, the things that do not decide whether a place is liveable but quietly earn it points when you are choosing. Shops within walking distance, a bit of history to the streets, somewhere to go on a day off. Olivine earns those points more than its numbers show. It has a real landmark, the Glitter Lighthouse, kept lit for Amphy the Ampharos, which tells you something about a town that organises itself around caring for one sick Pokemon (Bulbapedia, n.d.). Jasmine, the Gym Leader, reads locally as a quiet civic figure rather than a sports celebrity (Game Freak, 1999.). Everyday shopping is covered without the town being crowded, and what Olivine lacks it borrows, since Goldenrod's department store and radio tower are a short Magnet Train ride away and Ecruteak's history and festivals are closer still. You get a calm home base with a city's worth of options on a train line.

The runner up cities each have a different texture, and naming them makes the Olivine choice concrete rather than abstract. Cortondo in Paldea is an olive growing town built around a windmill, open and slow in the Mediterranean way, charming but light on amenities. Konikoni City in Alola is the opposite, a dense little market town packed with independent shops, a jeweller, apparel, a herbalist, exactly the sort of place a shopkeeper would love and a quiet soul might find busy. Cerulean in Kanto is pleasant and familiar, a calm northern city with its cape and its bike shop, but it carries the same thin cultural roots that pulled Kanto

down the table. Each is a real option. None quite matches Olivine's mix of calm, a landmark of its own, and a fast line to a bigger city.

4. Lifestyle and Pet Ownership

With a place chosen, the next question is what daily life there actually costs and what it is like. This section maps the institutions a resident deals with, the shape of housing and transport, the one healthcare fact that changes the whole budget, and then the pets themselves.

4.1 The institutions that touch daily life

Daily life in Olivine answers to a small, identifiable set of institutions, not an abstract state. The Pokemon League sets the rules Trainers operate under but has essentially no say over a civilian's daily life. The Gym, run by Jasmine, works locally more like a respected civic figure than a regulator. She is on record caring for her own Ampharos with the devotion any pet owner would recognise, which says something honest about how normal Pokemon companionship already is here, without a single line of new lore needing to be invented (Game Freak, 1999.). City hall and the Pokemon Center cover the two things that actually touch a resident's life, business registration and healthcare.

4.2 Housing and getting around

Housing splits between compact in town apartments and the Route 39 smallholdings just outside the city, and the choice mostly comes down to which pets are on the shortlist. The apartment suits a first year on a budget and the smaller pets. The smallholding costs more but earns its keep for anyone taking on a Mareep or a Ponyta that needs room. On the modelled figures the apartment runs near 55 thousand a month at Johto's baseline and the smallholding near 80 thousand, both before any regional adjustment, which for Johto is none.

Transport leans on walking, bicycle, and the regional Magnet Train network Johto is known for, which keeps a car unnecessary and removes a whole cost category a real relocation budget would carry (Game Freak, 1999.). That is not a small point. Take away a car, its fuel, and its upkeep, and one of the largest recurring line items in a normal household budget simply vanishes.

4.3 Healthcare, and why it changes the budget

Healthcare deserves its own line because it changes the cost model rather than just trimming it. Pokemon Centers heal Pokemon completely and for free, every time, and nothing in the games shows that care denied to a human resident either (Bulbapedia, n.d.). This report assumes it holds for people too, since nothing in canon contradicts it, and a good deal of incidental detail, free Center lodging for travellers among it, supports treating Pokemon Centers as a general community health service rather than a battling amenity. That single assumption removes the largest line item a real relocation budget would normally include, and it is flagged clearly as an assumption because so much of the affordability case rests on it.

4.4 Pets are matched to the life, not the breed

Here it helps to remember what a pet actually is in this world. It might breathe fire, read the tide, or take the ache out of a long day's work. That changes the whole question of what to keep. People do not pick a Pokemon the way they pick a breed of dog. They pick the one that fits how they live and what they do, and the animal's ability is usually the point.

You can see the pattern across the region if you look. Port and ferry crews keep water types like Marill or Wingull, animals at home around docks and boats. Farmers and smallholders keep Mareep or Miltank, because the wool and the milk offset their own keep (Serebii, n.d.). Night watchmen and late traders keep a Hoothoot for its nocturnal alertness and its habit of keeping exact time. Out on the cold and remote edges

of a region people keep a Growlithe, a loyal fire dog that warms a house and guards it. Carers and those in heavy physical trades favour a Galarian Ponyta, whose touch calms and helps heal, which after a hard day is worth more than it sounds. Couriers keep a Pidgey line bird for reliable message carrying. The through line is simple. The pet earns its place by fitting the life.

Trade or household	Typical Pokemon	Why it fits
Port and ferry crews	Marill or Wingull	water sense, buoyancy, comfortable around docks and boats
Farmers and smallholders	Mareep or Miltank	wool and dairy that offset their own upkeep
Night watch and late traders	Hoothoot	nocturnal alertness and exact timekeeping
Remote and mountain homes	Growlithe	warmth and guarding in a cold, isolated place
Carers and physical workers	Galarian Ponyta	a calming, gently healing presence after hard days
Couriers and travellers	Pidgey line	reliable homing and message carrying over distance

4.5 A first-time owner's shortlist in Olivine

For a first time civilian owner in Olivine, the sensible shortlist stays common, calm, and affordable, but it is chosen with that same lens. Marill fits a port household and the water is never far in Olivine. Sentret and Hoothoot suit an apartment and a quiet routine, one a daytime lookout, the other a night one. Mareep is the one that pays a little of its own way, since its sheared wool has real trade value on Routes 38 and 39, which the cost table does not even count as an offset (Serebii, n.d.). Growlithe and Galarian Ponyta sit at the higher end of the shortlist, more space and more feed, but both bring a genuine utility a normal pet cannot, warmth and guarding for one, a calming and healing presence for the other.

Pokemon	Acquisition (P/Y)	Annual Feed (P/Y)	Year 1 Total (P/Y)	Special utility
Marill	4,000	18,200	22,200	Water sense and natural buoyancy, a calm swimmer that suits a port or fishing household
Sentret	3,000	15,600	18,600	Constant lookout instinct, stands watch on its tail, a low-cost early-warning pet for a quiet home
Hoothoot	3,500	16,640	20,140	Keeps precise time and stays alert at night, suits a shift worker or a late-hours trade
Mareep	6,000	23,400	29,400	Static wool with real trade value on Routes 38 and 39, a pet that partly pays for itself
Growlithe	7,000	21,840	28,840	Loyal fire dog, warmth in a cold home and a genuine guard, favoured by remote and rural owners
Galarian Ponyta	9,000	26,000	35,000	A gentle horse whose touch soothes and helps heal, suited to carers and heavy manual trades

None of the six is rare, none demands a farm, and none carries a battling reputation that would make a neighbour nervous. Keeping any one of them runs somewhere between eighteen and thirty five thousand Pokedollars in the first year, with the apartment friendly trio at the lower end near eighteen to twenty two thousand. The cost falls meaningfully after that, once the one off cost of acquiring the animal stops repeating and only feed remains.

5. Business Feasibility, Part A. General Consumer Business

The business question runs on two tracks. The first is a normal consumer business, the kind that would exist in any town whether or not Pokemon were part of the picture. This section frames that track with the three Cs, tests its competitive intensity with Porter's five forces, and sketches how it would go to market with the marketing mix.

5.1 Company, customer, competitor

A general consumer business in Olivine answers three questions before anything else. Who is the company, who is the customer, and who is already serving them. The company is a relocating civilian with modest capital and no Trainer credentials to trade on, which rules out anything that leans on battling status. The customer is a mix of dockworkers, ferry travellers moving between the Whirl Islands and Kanto's Vermilion City, and residents who are not particularly interested in battling culture (Bulbapedia, n.d.). The competitor set is small and mostly informal, which is itself the finding worth acting on. Olivine has never been written as a retail or hospitality hub the way Goldenrod has, so the field is open in a way a mature city's would not be.

5.2 The five forces

Supplier power sits with the handful of Route 39 and Route 42 farms that feed the town, and it is moderate rather than high, because more than one farm sells into Olivine and none holds an exclusive lock on the port. Buyer power is low, since a ferry traveller with twenty minutes before the next departure is not price shopping. Rivalry among existing businesses is genuinely thin, which is the opening the whole track rests on. The threat of new entrants is real but not prohibitive, because port frontage is limited, so an early move ahead of any redevelopment matters more than deep capital. The threat of substitutes is modest, in the shape of vending machines and the Pokemon Center's own small shop, but neither delivers a sit down or a browsing experience. On balance the five forces point the same way. This is a thin, contestable market that rewards being early and being local.

5.3 The offer and the marketing mix

The offer that fits that gap is a dockside cafe with a small import retail counter attached, selling goods that already move through the port, Kanto snacks, Cianwood's medicinal specialties, the odd Sinnoh import for travellers who came the long way round. On product, the draw is a warm sit down stop and a shelf of things a traveller cannot easily get at home. On price, it sits mid market, aimed at travellers with a schedule rather than budget tourists. On place, it takes the port frontage itself, close enough to the ferry terminal to catch foot traffic without competing directly with the Pokemon Center. On promotion, it leans on word of mouth among ferry crews and a standing relationship with the harbourmaster's office rather than paid advertising, which barely exists as a concept in this setting anyway.

One honest note belongs here rather than buried later. On the scored options matrix, the single strongest standalone choice in this track is actually a ferry and tourism services shop, which rates highest on low competition and low setup cost. The dockside cafe comes a shade below it. The cafe still earns its place in the final recommendation, but not as the standalone winner of Track A. It earns it as the companion to the pet business in Track B, because the two share the same Route 39 feed supply and the same owner, and that shared supply chain is worth more than the ferry shop's slightly better standalone numbers. That is a judgement the matrix alone does not make, and it is flagged here in the open.

6. Business Feasibility, Part B. Pokemon Related Business

The second track is a business that only exists because Pokemon do. This section frames it with a SWOT, traces its value chain from farm to front door, and looks hard at the two institutions that could be mistaken for competition.

6.1 The value chain

A pet care business built around common Pokemon has a value chain that starts on Route 39's farms and ends at a customer's front door, and every link in between is something Olivine already half provides. Feed and berries come from the same smallholdings that would supply the dockside cafe in Track A, a genuine overlap rather than a coincidence, since the same relocating owner could plausibly run both. Grooming and boarding space needs modest square footage, nothing like a farm. Customer care itself, walk ins, drop offs, seasonal boarding around Whirl Cup travel season, is delivered entirely locally, with none of the distribution problems a physical goods business has to plan around.

6.2 The two institutions people mistake for competition

The honest competitive threat here is not another shop, it is the Pokemon Center and the regional Day Care, and both need to be understood rather than feared. The Pokemon Center offers free healthcare, which this report already assumes extends to any Pokemon regardless of owner, so a business cannot and should not try to compete on medical treatment (Bulbapedia, n.d.). The Day Care, the one on the Goldenrod approach road being the nearest of note, exists to raise and breed a Trainer's Pokemon for battling readiness, not to board a family pet for a long weekend (Bulbapedia, n.d.). That is a genuinely different service for a genuinely different customer, and it means grooming and boarding sits closer to a white space than a crowded market.

6.3 SWOT and the options matrix

Element	Assessment
Strengths	Free canon healthcare removes the hardest cost line. Route 39 and 42 already supply feed at scale. No existing boarding specialist in town.
Weaknesses	Owner has no Trainer credibility to lean on for trust. Seasonal demand around Whirl Cup travel could leave quiet months.
Opportunities	Growing casual pet ownership across Johto, shown informally by Jasmine's own Ampharos. Possible bundling with the Track A cafe.
Threats	A Day Care operator could widen into pet boarding. A feed supply shock on Route 39 would hit both revenue lines at once.

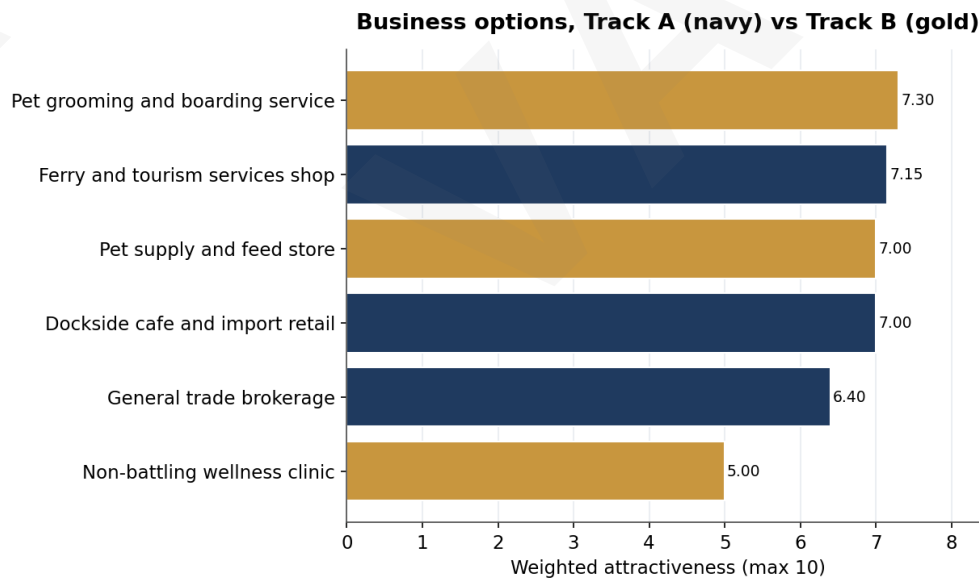


Figure 4. Business options, Track A in navy against Track B in gold, weighted attractiveness.

Pet grooming and boarding leads Track B clearly, and by a wider margin than any option led in Track A, which is itself a useful signal for the recommendation in the next section. The reason is the same white space the competitor analysis found. There is real demand, an existing supply chain, and no direct rival serving the family pet rather than the competitive roster.

7. Strategic Options

Putting a region and a business together turns nine regional scores and six business options into four real packages worth comparing side by side. This section names the four, makes the business case for the recommended one, and then maps where it could grow.

7.1 The four packages

The recommended package is Johto, Olivine City, built around pet grooming and boarding with the dockside cafe run alongside as a second revenue line. The ground floor package is Paldea, a small town such as Cortondo, the genuine runner up, trading Johto's settled institutions for the most open competitive field of any region. The lifestyle package is Alola, Konikoni City on Akala Island, the pick for anyone who weights warmth and climate above the last margin of safety, with the two axis culture score exactly why it rates as a serious third rather than a postcard. The comfort package is Kanto, likely Cerulean City, safe and familiar with no shame in it, but the weakest of the four on fit once culture is scored properly.

7.2 The business case for the recommendation

The business case for the recommended package is straightforward once written out plainly. The cost side is modest, a first year pet acquisition and feed budget in the tens of thousands of Pokedollars per animal, plus normal small business setup costs this report treats as broadly comparable to opening a small shop anywhere. The benefit side includes a genuinely underserved local market, a supply chain that already exists on the region's own farm routes, and a healthcare cost base of effectively zero thanks to the Pokemon Center assumption. Strategic fit is strong because the owner's stated goal, a normal life with pets and a small business, is exactly what Olivine's gap in the market rewards, rather than a stretch justification bolted on afterwards. Risk is real but bounded, and it is covered in full in the next section.

7.3 Where it grows

Growth from that start follows an Ansoff logic rather than open ended ambition. Market penetration inside Olivine is the easiest move and the lowest reward, simply winning more of the local custom. Market development into Cianwood and Goldenrod carries more upside once the home base is proven. Product development, adding pet transport and travel preparation for Whirl Cup season, sits in between on both feasibility and reward. Diversification into something unrelated scores lowest on both and is not recommended as a near term move. The order is deliberate. Prove the home base, then widen the map, and only then widen the product.

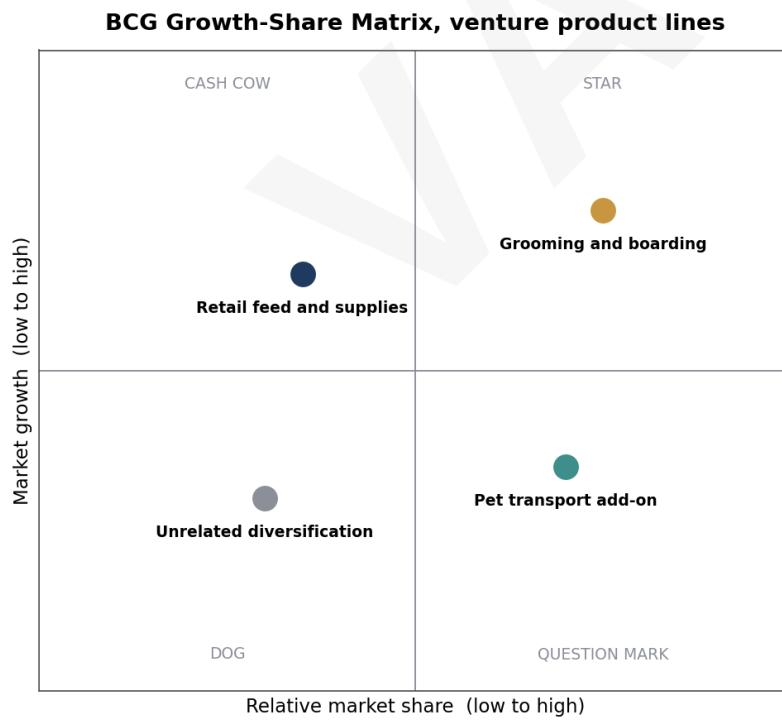


Figure 5. BCG Growth-Share Matrix for the venture's product lines once established.

Once the venture is running, the growth share matrix sorts its lines by where to put money. Grooming and boarding sit in the Star quadrant, worth continued investment. Retail feed and supplies behave like a Cash Cow, low growth but dependable, and a sensible place to fund expansion from rather than chase aggressively. The pet transport add on stays a Question Mark until proven and should remain a small, low commitment pilot rather than a headline offer. Nothing sits in the Dog quadrant by design, because the unrelated diversification that would land there is exactly the move the Ansoff analysis already ruled out.

8. Implementation Framework

A recommendation is only as good as the plan to carry it out. This section applies McKinsey's seven S model to the new venture and then sets a plain roadmap across a one, three, and five year horizon.

8.1 The seven S check

McKinsey's seven S is usually written for organisations with dozens of staff, and applying it to a shop this size can look oversized. It still earns its place, because even a two or three person operation has a strategy, a structure, systems, and the rest, it simply answers each in a sentence rather than a slide deck. Strategy is the pet care plus cafe package above. Structure is flat, an owner and one or two staff with no management layer between them. Systems are simple booking and stock tracking, nothing that needs specialist software at this scale. Staff are hired for animal handling comfort first and retail experience second. Skills the owner needs most are basic animal husbandry and inventory management, both learnable rather than rare. Shared values centre on treating pets as companions rather than stock, which is also the business's actual difference from the Day Care. Style of management is hands on and visible, the owner working the counter, not delegating from an office.

8.2 The roadmap

Horizon	Workstream	Milestone
Year 1	Relocation and registration	Secure Olivine premises, register with city hall, acquire the first two pets from the shortlist
Year 1	Launch	Open grooming and boarding with a soft launch aimed at dock and ferry staff, add the cafe counter once footfall is proven
Year 3	Market development	Extend boarding toward Cianwood, add a second staff member, formalise the Route 39 feed supply contract
Year 5	Consolidation	Two stable revenue lines, a proven seasonal peak, an optional low commitment transport pilot

The sequence matters more than the dates. The first year is about landing safely and opening the higher value line, the pet care, before the lower value cafe counter. The third year is about widening only once the home base holds. The fifth is about consolidation rather than reinvention, two steady lines and one small pilot, which is the shape of a business built to last rather than to impress.

9. Risk and Contingency

Every plan carries risk, and the honest test of this one is what its bad case actually looks like. This section runs three scenarios and then lists the specific risks with their mitigations.

9.1 Three scenarios

Best case, the business establishes itself within the first year, the pet care side outgrows the cafe within three, and Whirl Cup season traffic becomes a reliable annual peak rather than a hoped for one. Most likely case, growth is slower and more seasonal, the cafe carries the business through quieter months while boarding demand builds, and by year three the operation is stable rather than thriving. Worst case, a genuinely low probability event such as Ultra Wormhole spillover disrupting regional travel or a serious feed supply shock forces a temporary pause in one revenue line while the other carries it. None of the three point to outright failure, which is itself the strongest argument for this package over the alternatives. The downside here is a bad year, not a lost business, and that is the whole reason a two line structure was chosen over a single bet.

9.2 The risk register

Risk	Prob.	Impact	Score	Mitigation
Ultra Wormhole incursion with regional spillover	Low	High	3	Site the business away from known Alola-adjacent shipping routes, hold Pokemon Center emergency contacts on file
Weather-legendary reawakening (Groudon and Kyogre style event)	Low	High	3	Not applicable to Johto directly, monitor Hoenn news for supply chain effects only
Team Rocket nostalgia relapse or copycat crime	Low	Low	1	Standard insurance, no special provision given ten year resolved status
Seasonal demand swing around Whirl Cup travel	Medium	Medium	4	Run the cafe as a counter-seasonal second revenue line to smooth quiet months
Feed supply shock on Route 39 farms	Low	Medium	2	Contract two farms rather than one, hold four weeks of dry feed buffer

The register makes the shape of the risk clear. The high impact entries are all low probability standing phenomena that Johto does not carry directly, so their score stays low. The one medium entry is ordinary and manageable, the seasonal swing around Whirl Cup travel, and the two line structure is built precisely to smooth it. There is no single risk here that is both likely and severe, which is the profile you want before committing.

10. Conclusion and Recommendation

The sensible conclusion is not that every region is equally liveable for a civilian who wants pets and a small business. It is that the answer most people would guess, Kanto because it is familiar or Alola because it looks relaxing, is not quite the strongest once safety, cost, and both sides of culture are weighed properly. Johto wins that comparison, and Olivine turns the win into a specific plan, a pet grooming and boarding business anchored by a dockside cafe, built on a supply chain and a customer base that already exist in the source material rather than invented to fit.

That case is strong, but it is not the only reasonable one, and the report is better for saying so. Paldea is a real second choice for anyone who wants an open field and does not mind younger institutions. Alola is the right call for anyone who weights warmth and climate more heavily than this report's default weighting does. What the analysis rules out fairly clearly is Kalos and Unova as first moves, both exciting, both too expensive, and in Kalos's case too recently unsettled, for a first relocation on modest capital. Kanto remains the comfortable fallback, familiar and safe, just not the optimised one.

The immediate next steps are small and concrete. Confirm the Olivine premises and the Route 39 feed relationship, register with city hall, and take on the first two pets from the shortlist. Open the pet care line first and add the cafe counter once footfall is proven. Everything after that is a question of holding the course rather than changing it.

11. Glossary

Pokedollar. The in game currency, treated in this report as equal to Japanese yen at one to one, based on the original Japanese releases using yen directly.

Present day baseline. The Year 13 reference point used throughout, anchored to the confirmed five year gap between X and Y and Pokemon Legends Z-A.

Two axis culture score. The split of culture into rural and community warmth on one axis and low battle-culture pressure on the other, so that a region strong on one and weak on the other is scored honestly.

Track A and Track B. Shorthand for the general consumer business analysis and the Pokemon related business analysis respectively.

Weighted scoring matrix. A method that multiplies each option's raw scores by a set of criterion weights and sums them, so that judgement is made explicit and can be argued with rather than hidden.

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